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Preparation systems for efficiently generating alpha mattes and modified digital videos utilizing polarized light

Abstract

The present disclosure relates to systems, non-transitory computer-readable media, and methods for efficiently automating the preparation of accurate alpha matte animations and modified digital videos utilizing polarized light. For example, the disclosed systems obtain a plurality of polarized digital videos portraying an animation of a foreground subject backlit by a polarized light source. In some embodiments, the disclosed systems generate a plurality of corrected polarized digital videos by adjusting intensity values of the plurality of polarized digital videos based on intensity differences across the plurality of polarized digital videos. The disclosed systems generate an alpha matte animation comprising a plurality of alpha mattes from the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos or from the plurality of polarized digital videos. Utilizing the alpha matte animation, the disclosed systems generate a modified digital video by combining the animation of the foreground subject and a replacement background.

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

(1) Recent years have seen significant improvement in hardware and software platforms for implementing digital image or digital video matting processes. For example, matting systems can analyze digital images to combine portions of a digital image with an alternative background. For example, chroma key compositing involves capturing video animation of a foreground subject in front of a green background or a blue background, and replacing the green or blue color with the alternative background. Despite these improvements, the technical field suffers from a number of technical deficiencies, including inaccuracy in generating unrealistic and imprecise composite images, inflexibility of operation, and inefficiency in utilizing excessive time and computing resources.

BRIEF SUMMARY

(2) Embodiments of the present disclosure provide benefits and/or solve one or more problems in the art with systems, non-transitory computer-readable media, and methods for generating an alpha matte animation and generating a modified digital video utilizing polarized light. In particular, in one or more embodiments, the disclosed systems generate an alpha matte animation based on a plurality of polarized digital videos portraying an animation of a foreground subject and a polarized light source. For instance, the disclosed systems can utilize a polarized light source to generate marked and unmarked frames of polarized digital videos having different polarization angles. The disclosed systems can utilize these marked and unmarked frames to temporally and spatially crop the polarized digital videos and then utilize the different polarized angles to efficiently correct light intensity values. Specifically, the disclosed systems can utilize a closed-form expression of intensity values across digital videos having different polarization angles to generate a more accurate matte for each frame of the alpha matte animation. In some implementations, the disclosed

systems utilize a machine-learning model to generate the alpha matte animation based on the polarized digital videos. Additionally, in some embodiments, the disclosed systems generate the modified digital video based on the alpha matte animation by combining the animation of the foreground subject with a replacement background. Furthermore, in some embodiments, the disclosed systems utilize the resulting composite digital videos to generate a machine-learning training dataset comprising one or more machine-learning training videos (e.g., the modified digital video) and one or more ground truth alpha matte animations (e.g., the alpha matte animation).

(3) The following description sets forth additional features and advantages of one or more embodiments of the disclosed methods, non-transitory computer-readable media, and systems. In some cases, such features and advantages are evident to a skilled artisan having the benefit of this disclosure, or may be learned by the practice of the disclosed embodiments.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The detailed description provides one or more embodiments with additional specificity and detail through the use of the accompanying drawings, as briefly described below.
- (2) FIG. 1 illustrates a diagram of an environment in which a video matte preparation system operates in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (3) FIG. 2 illustrates an overview of the video matte preparation system generating an alpha matte animation utilizing polarized light and generating a modified digital video utilizing the alpha matte animation in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (4) FIG. 3 illustrates the video matte preparation system spatially cropping a digital video in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (5) FIG. 4 illustrates the video matte preparation system temporally cropping a digital video in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (6) FIG. 5 illustrates the video matte preparation system generating corrected polarized digital videos in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (7) FIG. 6 illustrates the video matte preparation system demosaicing a raw digital video into a plurality of polarized digital videos in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (8) FIG. 7 illustrates the video matte preparation system generating an alpha matte animation utilizing polarized digital videos in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (9) FIG. 8 illustrates the video matte preparation system generating modified digital videos utilizing an alpha matte animation in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (10) FIG. 9 illustrates the video matte preparation system harmonizing an animation of a foreground subject with a replacement background in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (11) FIGS. 10A and 10B illustrate outputs of the video matte preparation system in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (12) FIG. 11 illustrates a schematic diagram of an example architecture of a video matte preparation system in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (13) FIG. 12 illustrates a flowchart of a series of acts for generating an alpha matte animation and generating a modified digital video in accordance with one or more embodiments.
- (14) FIG. 13 illustrates a block diagram of an example computing device for implementing one or more embodiments of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (15) This disclosure describes one or more embodiments of a video matte preparation system that generates an alpha matte animation based on a plurality of polarized digital videos, and generates a modified digital video based on the alpha matte animation. Although some systems can generate masks for compositing video, such systems have a number of problems in relation to accuracy,

efficiency, and flexibility of operation. For instance, these systems inaccurately generate masks for a foreground subject. Specifically, existing systems often omit portions of the foreground subject that should be retained in the composited video and/or retain portions of the original background that should be omitted from the composited video. Accordingly, existing systems often generate composite images or videos that include unrealistic artifacts. Furthermore, existing systems poorly capture fine details, such as motion blur and human hair.

(16) Additionally, existing systems are inefficient. To illustrate, these systems often require extensive time, memory, and processing power to generate a composited video. Indeed, existing systems require significant time and computing resources to generate masks at each individual frame and overlay the foreground subject over the alternative background. Thus, preparation of training datasets for video matting machine-learning models utilizing existing systems is cost prohibitive due to substantial computational resources required.

(17) Furthermore, existing systems are inflexible in creating a composited video, requiring many user interactions (e.g., many user inputs, clicks, operations, manual edits). For instance, existing systems require numerous user inputs to setup a video, mask the video, crop the video, overlay the video onto an alternative background, and edit errors in the resulting composited video (such as artifacts from the original background or omissions of portions of the foreground subject). Thus, preparation of training datasets for video matting machine-learning models utilizing existing systems is labor prohibitive. The sheer volume of assets that need to be prepared for a high-quality, large-scale video matting dataset often requires hundreds of hours of manual frame-by-frame edits. For example, a single five-second video recorded at 30 frames per second consists of 150 frames that need different edits, such as spatial or temporal crop, alpha correction, and/or color decontamination before they can be used for training data. Furthermore, traditional solutions to build video matting datasets are too slow and too manual (e.g., stop-motion video), use over-constrained systems (e.g., static objects, high contrast subjects on a simple background, etc.), or use compromised ground-truth assets (e.g., assets having hand-painted alpha values, assets without motion blur, etc.). Therefore, existing solutions are not practical for large-scale video datasets that consist of hundreds or thousands of frames. Indeed, for this reason, in this field there is a lack of available training data reflecting digital videos and corresponding matte animations. The inaccuracy and inflexibility of existing systems has made ground truth matte animations and training datasets inordinately difficult to generate. Moreover, existing systems cannot efficiently composite large datasets of numerous images or videos with fine levels of detail (e.g., fine hair) or rapidly moving objects (e.g., blurred objects), which precludes existing systems from operating at scale.

(18) As mentioned above, in one or more embodiments the video matte preparation system utilizes polarized light and polarized digital videos to efficiently, accurately, and flexibly generate alpha matte animations and composite digital videos. For example, the video matte preparation system generates one or more alpha matte animations and one or more modified digital videos for creating training datasets for video matting machine-learning models. As another example, the video matte preparation system generates a modified digital video of a foreground subject (e.g., a person) composited with a replacement background (e.g., an exotic location or landscape) for digital video editing. By utilizing the techniques described herein, the video matte preparation system can rapidly and seamlessly generate large datasets of alpha matte animations and modified digital videos. As one example, the video matte preparation system crops unnecessary portions of the polarized digital videos without operator input, thereby reducing computer processing demands and eliminating a need for post-processing inputs.

(19) To illustrate, in some implementations, the video matte preparation system obtains a plurality of polarized digital videos portraying an animation of a foreground subject and a polarized light source. The video matte preparation system generates a plurality of correction metrics by comparing pixel-wise intensity values across corresponding frames of the plurality of polarized

digital videos. Utilizing the plurality of correction metrics, the video matte preparation system generates a plurality of corrected polarized digital videos by adjusting intensity values of the plurality of polarized digital videos. The video matte preparation system generates a plurality of alpha mattes from the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos. The video matte preparation system generates a modified digital video from the animation of the foreground subject and the plurality of alpha mattes.

(20) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system spatially and/or temporally crops one or more digital videos to remove unnecessary content from the digital videos. To illustrate, the video matte preparation system detects one or more markers on a polarized light source. The video matte preparation system identifies the one or more markers as indicators of one or more frames of the digital videos to remove in a temporal cropping procedure. To further illustrate, the video matte preparation system generates a spatial mask based on the markers. The video matte preparation system removes, in a spatial cropping procedure, portions of the digital videos that are spatially outside of the spatial mask.

(21) In some implementations, the video matte preparation system adjusts intensity values within the polarized digital videos to correct noise and/or other inaccuracies. For instance, the video matte preparation system utilizes a closed-form expression to efficiently generate pixel-wise intensity correction metrics based on intensity values of corresponding pixels within the polarized digital videos. The video matte preparation system adjusts intensity values of the pixels based on the intensity correction metrics, thereby generating corrected polarized digital videos.

(22) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system generates an alpha matte animation (e.g., a plurality of alpha matte frames) from the corrected polarized digital videos (or, alternatively, from the original polarized digital videos). Moreover, in some implementations, the video matte preparation system generates one or more modified digital videos, utilizing the alpha matte animation. For instance, the video matte preparation system combines the animation of the foreground subject and the replacement background. For example, the video matte preparation system efficiently generates a composited video, such as a video-conferencing call with a replacement background depicting a city skyline. Similarly, the video matte preparation system can generate a composite video within an entertainment setting with a replacement background depicting an exotic location. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system generates multiple modified digital videos by combining a single animation of the foreground subject and multiple replacement backgrounds, thereby efficiently generating multiple modified digital videos for a machine-learning training dataset.

(23) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system harmonizes the animation of the foreground subject with the replacement background. To illustrate, the video matte preparation system utilizes a harmonization machine learning model to harmonize the animation of the foreground subject with the replacement background.

(24) The video matte preparation system provides many advantages and benefits over existing systems and methods. For example, by utilizing polarized digital images in conjunction with correction and harmonization operations, the video matte preparation system improves accuracy of video mattes and modified digital videos relative to existing systems. Specifically, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system corrects pixel-wise intensity values from polarized digital videos to reduce or eliminate noise, visual artifacts, and/or other inaccuracies in the polarized digital videos. For example, the video matte preparation system generates digital videos with fine details of hair and/or motion blur. In some implementations, the video matte preparation system also reduces or eliminates artifacts from reflected light off a foreground subject by compositing a polarized digital image having a polarization angle orthogonal to the polarized light source. Further, the video matte preparation system harmonizes foreground subjects with replacement backgrounds to conform lighting appearance of a foreground subject with the scene of the replacement background.

(25) Additionally, by performing one or more of the disclosed methods, the video matte preparation system increases efficiency of video matting dataset preparation relative to existing systems. Specifically, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system spatially and/or temporally crops raw digital videos to decrease required processing operations, memory storage space, and time for generating alpha mattes and modified digital videos. Moreover, in some implementations, the video matte preparation system solves a closed-form expression for intensity correction metrics and intensity value adjustments to dramatically reduce required processing time for intensity corrections. Thus, the video matte preparation system can produce high-quality video training assets much faster than traditional methods.

(26) Furthermore, the video matte preparation system can offer increased flexibility of operation over existing systems. In particular, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system automatically crops—spatially and/or temporally—the raw digital videos, thereby introducing a new approach that also reduces the number of user interactions to edit a digital video. For instance, the video matte preparation system can reduce a number of parameters and/or manual settings required by existing systems to crop unwanted portions of a captured video. Furthermore, the video matte preparation system can alleviate manual setup steps required by existing systems (for example, chroma key compositing systems require careful setup of lighting to ensure that the green screen is adequately and uniformly lit). To illustrate, in some implementations, by utilizing polarized digital videos, the video matte preparation system composites detailed videos without a need for careful lighting setup. Moreover, the video matte preparation system also flexibly operates across a wide-range of digital videos, including videos with fine detail or rapidly moving objects. Additionally, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system introduces a new set of operations that allow for seamless creation of a composite digital video, including operations for spatially and/or temporally cropping polarized digital videos, correcting intensities of the polarized digital videos, demosaicing the digital videos, matting the digital videos, compositing the digital videos, and/or harmonizing the digital videos. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system implements some of these operations utilizing parallel processing, thereby further enhancing efficiency. For example, in some implementations, the video matte preparation system processes the digital videos in parallel (e.g., simultaneously) across all frames, including demosaicing, (optionally) intensity correction, denoising, alpha matting, color decontamination, compositing, and harmonization. Utilizing some or all of the disclosed techniques, the video matte preparation system can produce high-quality ground-truth alpha mattes for finely detailed and varyingly transparent still or moving objects in images and videos.

(27) Additional detail will now be provided in relation to illustrative figures portraying example embodiments and implementations of a video matte preparation system. For example, FIG. 1 illustrates a system **100** (or environment) in which a video matte preparation system **102** operates in accordance with one or more embodiments. As illustrated, the system **100** includes server device(s) **106**, a network **112**, and a client device **108**. As further illustrated, the server device(s) **106** and the client device **108** communicate with one another via the network **112**.

(28) As shown in FIG. 1, the server device(s) **106** includes a video management system **104** that further includes the video matte preparation system **102**. In one or more embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** generates a plurality of alpha mattes, such as an alpha matte animation. The video matte preparation system **102** also generates modified digital videos from initial digital videos using the plurality of alpha mattes. In some embodiments, the server device(s) **106** includes, but is not limited to, a computing device (such as explained below in reference to FIG. 13).

(29) In some instances, the video matte preparation system **102** receives a request from the client device **108** to generate a modified digital video. For example, the request includes an instruction to capture a digital video (or receive the digital video from another system) portraying an animation of a foreground subject, and to modify the digital video to overlay the animation of the foreground

subject over a replacement background.

(30) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** captures, utilizing a camera **120**, a digital video portraying an animation of a foreground subject **130** and polarized light from a polarized light source **140** behind the foreground subject **130**. For example, the camera **120** comprises one or more polarized filters to capture polarized light of various polarization angles. In this manner, the video matte preparation system **102** captures one or more polarized digital videos, each polarized digital video portraying the same scene, but with different light orientations depending on the polarization angle of the light captured in each of the polarized digital videos (i.e., depending on the polarization angle of the polarized filter associated with the particular polarized digital video). Therefore, in some embodiments, the system **100** includes the camera **120** and the polarized light source **140** for use by the video matte preparation system **102**. In one or more embodiments, including the illustrated embodiment, the video matte preparation system **102** communicates with the camera **120** and/or the polarized light source **140** through the client device **108**. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** communicates directly with the camera **120** and/or the polarized light source **140** through the network **112**. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** stores the digital videos (e.g., the polarized digital videos) captured by the camera **120**. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** receives the polarized digital videos from another system.

(31) Furthermore, as shown in FIG. **1**, the system **100** includes the client device **108**. In some embodiments, the client device **108** includes, but is not limited to, a mobile device (e.g., smartphone, tablet), a laptop computer, a desktop computer, or any other type of computing device, including those explained below in reference to FIG. **13**. Some embodiments of client device **108** are operated by a user to perform a variety of functions via a client application **110** on client device **108**. For example, the client device **108** (through the client application **110**) performs functions such as, but not limited to, requesting capture of one or more digital videos, selecting or submitting replacement backgrounds (e.g., selecting replacement background images or replacement background videos stored in a database accessible to the video matte preparation system **102**), and/or requesting modification of one or more digital videos with one or more replacement backgrounds.

(32) To access the functionalities of the video matte preparation system **102** (as described above and in greater detail below), in one or more embodiments, a user interacts with the client application **110** on the client device **108**. For example, the client application **110** includes one or more software applications (e.g., to interact with and/or modify digital videos in accordance with one or more embodiments described herein) installed on the client device **108**, such as a video matte preparation application. In certain instances, the client application **110** is hosted on the server device(s) **106**. Additionally, when hosted on the server device(s) **106**, the client application **110** is accessed by the client device **108** through a web browser and/or another online interfacing platform and/or tool.

(33) Although FIG. **1** illustrates the video matte preparation system **102** being implemented by a particular component and/or device within the system **100** (e.g., the server device(s) **106**), in some embodiments the video matte preparation system **102** is implemented, in whole or in part, by other computing devices and/or components in the system **100**. For instance, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** is implemented on the client device **108** within the client application **110**. More specifically, in one or more embodiments, the description of (and acts performed by) the video matte preparation system **102** are implemented by (or performed by) the client application **110** on the client device **108**.

(34) In some embodiments, the client application **110** includes a web hosting application that allows the client device **108** to interact with content and services hosted on the server device(s) **106**. To illustrate, in one or more implementations, the client device **108** accesses a web page or computing application supported by the server device(s) **106**. The client device **108** provides input

to the server device(s) **106** (e.g., files of polarized digital videos, selection of a replacement background). In response, the video matte preparation system **102** on the server device(s) **106** performs operations described herein to generate an alpha matte animation and/or a modified digital video. The server device(s) **106** provides the output or results of the operations (e.g., the modified digital video) to the client device **108**.

(35) Additionally, as shown in FIG. 1, the system **100** includes the network **112**. As mentioned above, in some instances, the network **112** enables communication between components of the system **100**. In certain embodiments, the network **112** includes a suitable network and may communicate using any communication platforms and technologies suitable for transporting data and/or communication signals, examples of which are described with reference to FIG. 13. Furthermore, although FIG. 1 illustrates the server device(s) **106** and the client device **108** communicating via the network **112**, in certain embodiments, the various components of the system **100** communicate and/or interact via other methods (e.g., the server device(s) **106** and the client device **108** communicate directly).

(36) As discussed above, the video matte preparation system **102** can generate an alpha matte animation and a modified digital video from a plurality of polarized digital videos. For instance, FIG. 2 illustrates the video matte preparation system **102** generating alpha mattes and constructing a modified video utilizing the alpha mattes and based on an input video in accordance with one or more embodiments. Specifically, FIG. 2 shows a process flow in which the video matte preparation system **102** obtains a digital video **202** (e.g., multiple digital images as a series of video frames), generates an alpha matte animation **204** (e.g., multiple alpha mattes as a series of frames of the alpha matte animation), and generates a modified digital video **206** (e.g., multiple modified digital images as a series of modified video frames). In some implementations, the alpha matte animation **204** can be used as is and does not require further edits.

(37) For example, a polarized digital video includes a digital video captured through a polarized filter of a camera. Thus, a polarized digital video comprises frames depicting polarized light at an angle matching a polarization angle of the polarized filter. In addition, a digital video includes one or more videos depicting a scene. In some embodiments, a digital video includes a plurality of polarized digital videos, wherein each of the plurality of polarized digital videos depicts the same scene from the same vantage point. For example, while each of the plurality of polarized digital videos comprise different light orientations based on their polarization angles, they portray the same scene and together make up the digital video. Thus, the description herein of the digital video is also applicable to the plurality of digital videos.

(38) A polarization angle includes an angle at which polarized light is emitted, reflected, or captured. For example, the polarization angle of a polarized light source is the angle at which the polarized light source emits light. Similarly, the polarization angle of a polarized filter is the angle of light at which the polarized filter permits light to pass through.

(39) An animation includes a plurality of frames of a video. Often, an animation includes motion of one or more subjects and/or objects in the video. In some cases, the animation includes only subtle motion, or no motion at all, of the one or more subjects and/or objects. In some embodiments, a foreground subject includes a person or a group of people. In some embodiments, a foreground subject includes an animate or inanimate object.

(40) In some embodiments, a polarized light source includes a light source that emits or reflects polarized light at a particular polarization angle. For example, a polarized light source can include a device that emits light at a 0-degree polarization angle (or any other angle). To illustrate, a polarized light source includes a television or a computer monitor that emits polarized light. As another example, a polarized light source includes a custom polarized light source having a polarized filter (e.g., at a particular polarization angle, such as 0 degrees) and even lighting positioned behind the polarized filter. In some implementations, the polarized light source is positioned behind the foreground subject to provide polarized backlighting for capturing polarized

digital videos. In some implementations, the polarized light source is a polarized filter mounted on a diffuse material that reflects ambient light for illumination.

(41) An alpha matte includes a map of values representing foreground (e.g., a binary 1), background (e.g., a binary 0), and combination/alpha values (e.g., a value between 0 and 1). For instance, an alpha matte includes foreground, background, and alpha values for combining two or more images. For example, an alpha matte includes a map of pixel-values in grayscale between white and black (or represented numerically, such as between zero and one). To illustrate, an alpha matte contains pixel-wise information about how much of an input image to retain in an output image.

(42) An alpha matte animation includes a series or sequence of a plurality of alpha mattes. For instance, an alpha matte animation contains pixel-wise information about how much of an animation of a foreground subject to retain and how much of a replacement background to retain in a combined animation (e.g., a modified digital video).

(43) A modified digital video includes a digital video of a foreground subject with at least a portion of the digital video replaced with pixels of a replacement background. For example, a modified digital video is a video of the animation of the foreground subject superimposed over a replacement background.

(44) A replacement background is a background different from the background of an original digital video (e.g., different from the backlighting of the polarized light source). For instance, a replacement background is a view of a different scene than the scene of the original capture of the digital video. In some embodiments, a replacement background is a still-frame image for multiple frames of the animation of the foreground subject. In some embodiments, a replacement background is a video of a scene (e.g., a replacement background video).

(45) As shown in FIG. 2, the video matte preparation system **102** captures the digital video **202** portraying an animation of a foreground subject **230** backlit by a polarized light source **240**. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** captures the digital video **202** utilizing one or more polarized filters of a camera. Thus, the video matte preparation system **102** captures the digital video **202** comprising one or more polarized digital videos portraying the animation of the foreground subject **230** backlit by the polarized light source **240**. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** captures two polarized digital videos portraying the animation. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** captures three polarized digital videos portraying the animation. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** captures four polarized digital videos portraying the animation. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** captures five, six, or more polarized digital videos portraying the animation.

(46) In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** obtains the digital video **202** portraying the animation of the foreground subject **230** backlit by the polarized light source **240**. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** obtains the digital video **202** without directly capturing the digital video **202**. To illustrate, the video matte preparation system **102** obtains the digital video **202** comprising the one or more polarized digital videos portraying the animation of the foreground subject **230** backlit by the polarized light source **240**. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** receives the plurality of polarized digital videos from another system that previously captured and/or stored the plurality of polarized digital videos.

(47) In capturing multiple polarized digital videos of the same scene, the video matte preparation system **102** can capture frames across the polarized digital videos that correspond to the same points in time. Accordingly, corresponding frames (or matching frames) include frames of a plurality of digital videos (e.g., the plurality of polarized digital videos) captured at the same time (or nearly the same time, such as within a hundredth of a second threshold) and reflecting the same scene with the same vantage point (or nearly the same vantage point, such as within one millimeter). For example, corresponding frames are the several frames captured at the same instant

by a camera with multiple filters. In some cases, the foreground subject is motionless or nearly motionless (such as a still object). Thus, corresponding frames of the polarized digital videos can include frames captured at different times. To illustrate, the video matte preparation system **102** captures a frame of a first polarized digital video utilizing a polarization filter having a first polarization angle, a frame of a second polarized digital video utilizing a polarization filter having a second polarization angle, and so forth. These frames, each depicting the same still object in the same orientation, are corresponding frames notwithstanding being captured at different times.

(48) Similarly, corresponding pixels (or matching pixels) across frames of polarized digital videos are pixels in corresponding frames at the same location (or nearly the same location, such as within a 2 pixel radius). For example, the upper-left-most pixels of corresponding frames of polarized digital videos are corresponding pixels. In some embodiments, a camera with multiple polarization filters captures and stores light in a grid (e.g., a two-by-two grid) of pixels, with one or more pixels in the grid captured by one filter, and one or more other pixels in the grid captured by another filter, etc. In such embodiments, the pixels in the grid are corresponding pixels.

(49) As shown FIG. 2, the video matte preparation system **102** generates alpha mattes from the plurality of polarized digital videos. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the plurality of polarized digital videos to construct the alpha matte animation **204**. The alpha matte animation **204** includes a plurality of alpha mattes (e.g., one alpha matte for each frame of the animation). Accordingly, the alpha matte animation **204** represents a degree to which the foreground subject **230** obstructs the polarized light source **240** in the digital video **202**. For example, where a portion of the foreground subject **230** fully obstructs the polarized light source **240**, the alpha matte animation **204** has white pixels (e.g., represented by the numeral 1). Where another portion of the foreground subject **230** partially obstructs the polarized light source **240**, the alpha matte animation **204** has gray pixels (e.g., represented by a numeral between 0 and 1). Where the foreground subject **230** does not obstruct the polarized light source **240**, the alpha matte animation **204** has black pixels (e.g., represented by the numeral 0).

(50) The example of the alpha matte animation depicted in FIG. 2 is illustrative and nonlimiting. For instance, in some embodiments, the alpha matte animation has black pixels corresponding to opaque portions of the foreground subject **230**, and white pixels corresponding to portions without the foreground subject **230**. In some embodiments, the pixels of the alpha matte animation are not represented by colors, but rather by numbers in an array denoting, for example, a percentage of pixels of the foreground subject **230** to combine with a replacement background **270** to create a modified digital video **206**.

(51) Utilizing the alpha matte animation **204**, the video matte preparation system **102** generates the modified digital video **206** by combining the foreground subject **230** and a replacement background **270**. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** superimposes pixels of the digital video **202** corresponding with the foreground subject **230** onto the replacement background **270**. In some embodiments, the replacement background **270** is a digital image. In some embodiments, the replacement background **270** is a digital video.

(52) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** combines the pixels of the foreground subject **230** from the digital video **202** with the replacement background **270** based on the alpha matte animation **204**. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the pixel-wise values of the alpha matte animation **204** to combine colors of the pixels of the replacement background **270** with the colors of the pixels of the foreground subject **230** in the digital video **202**. For instance, if a particular pixel of the alpha matte animation **204** is represented by the numeral 0.5, the video matte preparation system **102** generates a corresponding pixel of the modified digital video **206** by averaging (equally) the corresponding pixels of the digital video **202** and the replacement background **270**.

(53) In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes a weighted average of pixels to generate the modified digital video **206**. For instance, if a particular pixel of the alpha

matte animation **204** is represented by the numeral 0.8 (e.g., the foreground subject **230** is 80% opaque and 20% transparent), the video matte preparation system **102** combines the corresponding pixels of the digital video **202** and the replacement background **270** by weighting the corresponding pixel of the digital video **202** four times more than the corresponding pixel of the replacement background.

(54) As mentioned above, the video matte preparation system **102** can spatially crop a digital video. Specifically, FIG. **3** illustrates the video matte preparation system **102** obtaining a digital video **302**, detecting markers **340** in the digital video **302**, generating a spatial mask **360** for the digital video **302**, and removing portions of the digital video **302** to create a spatially cropped digital video **308**, in accordance with one or more embodiments.

(55) For example, the video matte preparation system **102** spatially crops the digital video **302** (e.g., the digital video **202**) by spatially cropping the plurality of polarized digital videos. In this way, the video matte preparation system **102** removes corresponding portions (e.g., portions comprising corresponding pixels within corresponding frames) of each of the plurality of polarized digital videos.

(56) As mentioned, the video matte preparation system **102** can include markers. For example, a marker includes a symbol or identifiable visual indicator. For example, in some implementations a marker includes a digital marker, such as a QR code or other visual encoding of information. The QR code, for example, can reflect embedded information, such as a video title, a time, or a location. In some cases, a marker includes a physical marker, such as light cast onto a scene (e.g., a laser) or a physical sign (e.g., a placard held at a particular location in physical space). In some embodiments, a marker includes a hybrid marker comprising both digital and physical elements, such as a combination of light cast onto the scene and a digital symbol in the polarized light source. Similarly, a marker frame includes a frame of a polarized digital video that portrays polarized light having one or more markers. Moreover, a non-marker frame includes a frame of a polarized digital video that does not portray polarized light having one or more marker. While a non-marker frame does portray polarized light, it does not include markers.

(57) In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** prepares a spatial mask based on one or more markers. For example, a spatial mask includes a map identifying pixels to include or exclude from a digital video. To illustrate, a spatial mask can include a binary mask (e.g., comprising ones and zeros) that informs which portions of a frame of a digital video to remove in a cropping technique.

(58) In relation to FIG. **3**, the video matte preparation system **102** detects the markers **340** in the digital video **302**. For instance, the video matte preparation system **102** observes a plurality of markers **340** on one or more frames of the digital video **302**. To illustrate, the plurality of polarized digital videos comprises marker frames portraying the polarized light source **240** having the plurality of markers **340**. In FIG. **3**, the digital video **302** portrays the polarized light source **240** with four markers **340**: one marker **340** in each corner of the polarized light source **240**. This configuration is illustrative and nonlimiting. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** detects more or fewer than four markers **340**. In some embodiments, the markers **340** are arranged in patterns other than the rectangular pattern shown in FIG. **3**.

(59) As shown in FIG. **3**, the video matte preparation system **102** generates a spatial mask **360** based on the detected markers **340**. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** determines locations (e.g., pixels) of the plurality of markers **340** and creates the spatial mask **360** to enclose the locations of the plurality of markers **340**. To illustrate, in some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** determines pixels to retain for the spatially cropped digital video **308**, and other pixels to remove from the digital video **302** (i.e., exclude from the spatially cropped digital video **308**). In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** determines an initial region by connecting the plurality of markers **340** and then determines the spatial mask **360** by expanding the initial region (e.g., by expanding by a threshold number of

pixels such as 10, 20, or 50). Thus, the spatial mask comprises information about which pixels to retain and which pixels to remove.

(60) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** spatially crops the plurality of polarized digital videos utilizing the plurality of markers **340** from the polarized light source **240** portrayed in the marker frames. For instance, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the spatial mask **360** to remove portions of the digital video **302** (e.g., portions of the plurality of polarized digital videos) that are outside of the spatial mask. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** generates a new digital video (e.g., the spatially cropped digital video **308**, and/or a plurality of spatially cropped polarized digital videos). In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** modifies the original video (e.g., the digital video **302**, and/or the plurality of polarized digital videos) to create the spatially cropped digital video **308** by removing the portions outside of the spatial mask (e.g., without necessarily generating the new digital video).

(61) In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** detects the markers **340** on some frames (e.g., one or more marker frames) of the digital video **302**, and not on other frames (e.g., one or more non-marker frames) of the digital video **302**. To illustrate, the plurality of polarized digital videos comprises marker frames and non-marker frames, wherein the marker frames portray the polarized light source **240** having the plurality of markers **340**, and wherein the non-marker frames portray the polarized light source **240** without the plurality of markers **340**. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** spatially crops the digital video **302** (e.g., spatially crops the plurality of polarized digital videos) by cropping the non-marker frames of the digital video **302**. In this way, the video matte preparation system **102** generates a spatial mask **360** for the non-marker frames based on the plurality of markers **340** from the polarized light source **240** portrayed in the marker frames. Then, the video matte preparation system **102** removes portions of the non-marker frames that are outside of the spatial mask **360**.

(62) By spatially cropping the plurality of polarized digital videos, in some embodiments the video matte preparation system **102** provides enhanced efficiency over existing video matting systems. For instance, by automatically removing portions of the polarized digital videos, the video matte preparation system **102** reduces memory storage size requirements for the digital videos, as well as processing resources and processing time for additional operations and/or techniques described herein, resources and time that would otherwise be consumed operating on those removed portions were they to remain in the polarized digital videos.

(63) Additionally, by utilizing the markers and automatically generating a spatial mask, in some embodiments the video matte preparation system **102** alleviates otherwise necessary inputs, clicks, steps, and/or operations to crop and/or edit the digital videos. To illustrate, by utilizing the spatial cropping techniques described above, the video matte preparation system **102** can eliminate a need for carefully aligning the camera with the polarized light source **240**. In general, portions of the digital video **302** outside of the polarized light source **240** would not yield viable alpha mattes for video compositing (e.g., the light intensity for pixels outside of the polarized light source **240** would generally be approximately equal for each of the plurality of polarized digital videos, and thus the alpha mattes would not correctly differentiate between the foreground subject and the background in those areas outside of the polarized light source **240**). Thus, by spatially cropping the plurality of polarized digital videos in accordance with some embodiments as described herein, the video matte preparation system **102** alleviates otherwise necessary setup steps (such as carefully aligning and zooming the camera to line up with the polarized light source **240**) and/or alleviates otherwise necessary post-processing steps to spatially crop the plurality of polarized digital videos.

(64) As also mentioned, the video matte preparation system **102** can temporally crop a digital video. For example, FIG. 4 illustrates the video matte preparation system **102** obtaining a digital video **402** comprising frames **402a-402z** and temporally cropping a subset of the frames **402a-402z** from the digital video **402**, in accordance with one or more embodiments. As explained above,

description herein of a singular digital video is illustrative and nonlimiting, and applies equally to a plurality of polarized digital videos (e.g., each polarized digital video comprises corresponding frames **402a-402z**).

(65) For example, in some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** detects one or more marker frames within the digital video **402**, and one or more non-marker frames within the digital video **402**. For instance, similar to the description above in connection with FIG. 3, the video matte preparation system **102** detects one or more markers **440** on some frames (e.g., one or more marker frames) of the digital video **402**, and not on other frames (e.g., one or more non-marker frames) of the digital video **402**. To further illustrate, the digital video **402** comprises marker frames **402a-402j** and **402n-402z**, and non-marker frames **402k-402m**, wherein the marker frames **402a-402j** and the marker frames **402n-402z** portray the polarized light source having the plurality of markers **440**, and wherein the non-marker frames **402k-402m** portray the polarized light source without the plurality of markers **440**.

(66) The video matte preparation system **102** temporally crops the digital video **402** by removing the marker frames **402a-402j** and the marker frames **402n-402z** from the digital video **402**, while retaining the non-marker frames **402k-402m**. Thus, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** creates a temporally cropped digital video consisting of the non-marker frames **402k-402m**.

(67) Similar to the description above in connection with FIG. 3, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** generates a new digital video (or a plurality of new polarized digital videos) comprising the temporally cropped digital video (or a plurality of temporally cropped polarized digital videos) without the marker frames **402a-402j** and without the marker frames **402n-402z**. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** modifies the original video (e.g., the digital video **402**, and/or the plurality of polarized digital videos) to create the temporally cropped digital video by removing the marker frames **402a-402j** and the marker frames **402n-402z** (e.g., without necessarily generating the new digital video). In some embodiments, the digital video **402** comprises one or more marker frames **402a-402j** and one or more non-marker frames **402k-402m**, without additional marker frames **402n-402z** following the non-marker frames **402k-402m**.

(68) By temporally cropping the plurality of polarized digital videos, the video matte preparation system **102** can provide enhanced efficiency over existing video matting systems. For instance, by automatically removing frames of the polarized digital videos, in some implementations the video matte preparation system **102** reduces memory storage size requirements for the digital videos, as well as processing resources and processing time for additional operations and/or techniques described herein, resources and time that would otherwise be consumed operating on those removed frames were they to remain in the polarized digital videos. Additionally, by utilizing the marker frames and the non-marker frames to automatically remove the marker frames, in one or more embodiments the video matte preparation system **102** alleviates unnecessary inputs, clicks, steps, and/or operations to crop and/or edit the digital videos.

(69) As mentioned above, the video matte preparation system **102** can adjust light intensity values for the plurality of polarized digital videos. For instance, FIG. 5 illustrates, in accordance with one or more embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** comparing pixel-wise intensity values across corresponding frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos and generating a plurality of corrected polarized digital videos by adjusting intensity values of the plurality of polarized digital videos. A corrected polarized digital video includes a polarized digital video that has been adjusted using intensity correction techniques. Similarly, an intensity value includes a measurement or other parameter representing light intensity, brightness, luminosity, radiance, or luminance. For example, an intensity value includes a measure of an amount of light portrayed in a digital video, and in particular, in a pixel of the digital video.

(70) Specifically, FIG. 5 shows a frame **502** of a first polarized digital video, a frame **504** of a

second polarized digital video, a frame **506** of a third polarized digital video, and a frame **508** of a fourth polarized digital video. The frames **502**, **504**, **506**, and **508** are corresponding frames, meaning that they correspond to the same moment in time of capture of the digital video and, therefore, portray the same foreground subject in the same pose. However, the frames **502**, **504**, **506**, and **508** portray different intensities of background light because the frames **502**, **504**, **506**, and **508** were each captured through different polarized filters of a camera. To illustrate, frame **502** comprises polarized light at a first polarization angle (e.g., 0 degrees), frame **504** comprises polarized light at a second polarization angle orthogonal to the first polarization angle (e.g., 90 degrees), frame **506** comprises polarized light at a third polarization angle (e.g., 45 degrees), and frame **508** comprises polarized light at a fourth polarization angle orthogonal to the third polarization angle (e.g., 135 degrees).

(71) The description herein of polarization angles of 0, 45, 90, and 135 degrees is exemplary only. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes polarization angles having other values (e.g., 1, 46, 91, and 136 degrees). In some preferred embodiments, one of the polarization angles is orthogonal to the polarization angle of the polarized light source. For instance, if the polarized light source emits light at a polarization angle of 0 degrees, the video matte preparation system **102** obtains a polarized digital video (e.g., the second polarized digital video) comprising polarized light at 90 degrees (as well as unpolarized light). In this way, in one of the polarized digital videos, the video matte preparation system **102** can block out the polarized light from the polarized light source.

(72) As depicted in FIG. 5, the frame **502** comprises relatively bright light from the background polarized light source, while frame **504** comprises essentially no light from the background polarized light source. This is because the polarized filter through which frame **502** was captured is aligned with the polarization angle of the polarized light source, whereas the polarized filter through which frame **504** was captured is orthogonal to the polarization angle of the polarized light source. Relatedly, frames **506** and **508** each comprise moderately bright light from the polarized light source, because they were captured through polarized filters that are angled (neither orthogonal nor directly aligned) with the polarization angle of the polarized light source.

(73) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** measures intensity values of light in the polarized digital videos. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** measures pixel-wise intensity values in frames **502**, **504**, **506**, and **508**. In theory, for any given pixel and its corresponding pixels across corresponding frames **502**, **504**, **506**, and **508**, the intensity values should (approximately) satisfy the following equation:

$$(74) I_0 + I_{90} = I_{45} + I_{135}$$

where the variables I represent light intensity values; the subscripts 0 and 90 denote a first polarization angle aligned with the polarized light source and a second polarization angle orthogonal to the first polarization angle, respectively; and the subscripts 45 and 135 denote a third polarization angle and a fourth polarization angle orthogonal to the third polarization angle, respectively. In some embodiments, the third and fourth polarization angles have 45 degree offsets from the first and second polarization angles. Thus, the sum of intensity values of the first and second polarization angles should (approximately) equal the sum of intensity values of the third and fourth polarization angles.

(75) In practice, the measured intensity values do not always satisfy this equation. To illustrate, noise and visual artifacts are introduced into the captured polarized digital videos. For example, ambient light (which is generally unpolarized) can, when reflected off of a surface of the foreground subject, become polarized. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** compares pixel-wise intensity values across corresponding frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** computes pixel-wise magnitudes of intensity differences across the plurality of polarized digital videos. An intensity difference includes a metric representing a pixel-wise comparison of two or more intensity values.

Thus, an intensity difference represents differences in the amount, radiance, brightness, luminosity, or luminance of light portrayed in corresponding pixels of corresponding frames of a plurality of digital videos (e.g., a plurality of polarized digital videos). In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** computes intensity differences according to the following formula:

$$(76) \text{.Math. } I_0 - I_{45} + I_{90} - I_{135} \text{.Math.}$$

(77) As explained above, these magnitudes of intensity differences should, in theory, equal zero (or approximately zero). The video matte preparation system **102** determines these intensity differences for each pixel across corresponding frames of the polarized digital videos. As illustrated in FIG. 5, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** generates a heat map **510** of intensity differences for a frame of the digital video (e.g., for corresponding frames of the polarized digital videos). As can be seen in FIG. 5, the heat map **510** demonstrates noise and/or artifacts in the polarized digital videos. For example, a locus of nonzero intensity differences can be seen in the heat map **510** (the locus outlining the pose of the foreground subject in the digital video).

(78) An intensity correction metric, or simply a correction metric, includes a measure for adjusting light intensities in corresponding pixels of the polarized digital videos. For example, an intensity correction metric defines an extent to which corresponding pixels violate a condition of light intensity balance. Accordingly, an intensity correction metric represents how much corresponding pixels should be adjusted (e.g., as part of an intensity correction technique).

(79) In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** adjusts the intensity values for the various pixels of the polarized digital videos. To illustrate, the video matte preparation system **102** generates correction metrics for the polarized digital videos. The correction metrics include pixel-wise metrics that represent an extent to which the determined intensity differences at the various pixels are nonzero. The video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the correction metrics to adjust light intensities in the polarized digital videos, thereby reducing or eliminating noise and/or visual artifacts in the polarized digital videos.

(80) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** generates correction metrics according to the following equation:

$$(81) s = \frac{I_0 - I_{45} + I_{90} - I_{135}}{\text{.Math. } I^2}$$

where the s is a correction metric (i.e., a scalar correction metric) for a particular pixel in the digital video. The denominator contains an overall intensity value, in which the intensity values are squared and summed (i.e., ϕ represents a summation index for each of the plurality of polarized digital videos). The video matte preparation system **102** generates unique values of the intensity correction metric s for each pixel of a digital video.

(82) In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** generates an overall intensity value. An overall intensity value includes a combination of intensity values of corresponding pixels. In some embodiments, an overall intensity value is a sum of the squares of the corresponding pixels' intensity values.

(83) To adjust the intensity values of the polarized digital videos, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the intensity correction metrics according to the following closed-form expressions:

$$(84) I'_0 = I_0 (1 - sI_0) I'_{45} = I_{45} (1 + sI_{45}) I'_{90} = I_{90} (1 - sI_{90}) I'_{135} = I_{135} (1 + sI_{135})$$

where the variables I' are adjusted intensity values. The video matte preparation system **102** solves these closed-form expressions of intensity values for the polarized digital videos to generate the adjusted intensity values. An adjusted intensity value includes a value of light intensity for a pixel of a polarized digital video that has been corrected (e.g., according to an intensity correction technique).

(85) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the adjusted intensity values to generate corrected polarized digital videos. For instance, FIG. 5 shows frames of

corrected polarized digital videos (although these corrections may not be observable at the scale of FIG. 5). Specifically, frame **522** is a corrected frame based on frame **502** of the first polarized digital video, frame **524** is a corrected frame based on frame **504** of the second polarized digital video, frame **526** is a corrected frame based on frame **506** of the third polarized digital video, and frame **528** is a corrected frame based on frame **508** of the fourth polarized digital video.

(86) In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** generates a heat map **530** of intensity differences for a frame of the corrected digital video (e.g., for corresponding frames of the corrected polarized digital videos). As can be seen in FIG. 5, the heat map **530** demonstrates that the noise and/or artifacts (which are visible in heat map **510** for the polarized digital videos) has been removed and is not present in the corrected polarized digital videos. For example, as can be seen in the heat map **530**, the intensity differences are zero for all pixels of the corresponding frames of the corrected polarized digital videos.

(87) The process of correcting intensities in the polarized digital videos has several advantages that can enhance the quality and efficiency of the video matte preparation system **102**. For instance, by generating the corrected polarized digital videos, in one or more embodiments the video matte preparation system **102** reduces or removes noise and/or visual artifacts from the digital video, thereby increasing the accuracy of alpha matte animations and modified digital videos. For example, as can be seen in the heat map **510**, the noise represented by the nonzero intensity differences would cause inaccuracies around the outline of the foreground subject (e.g., blurred hairlines, unrealistic boundaries between the foreground subject and the replacement background, etc.). However, by applying intensity correction (i.e., by generating corrected polarized digital videos), the video matte preparation system **102** can reduce or eliminate noise (as seen in the heat map **530**), thereby enhancing the quality of the alpha mattes and the modified digital videos. As discussed in further detail below, in one or more embodiments the video matte preparation system **102** generates high-quality modified digital videos with crisp and finely detailed boundaries between a foreground subject and a replacement background, and with detailed translucent portions of the alpha mattes that represent motion blur or translucent surfaces with other objects visible in the background.

(88) In addition, by applying the process described above of solving closed-form expressions of intensity values, the video matte preparation system **102** can efficiently generate the corrected polarized digital videos. For instance, the closed-form expressions of intensity values yield direct solutions, and do not require iterative or recursive methods for solving for the adjusted intensity values. In this way, the video matte preparation system **102** can increase efficiency over existing video matting systems by reducing required computational steps and time. Furthermore, the video matte preparation system **102** can increase flexibility over existing video matting systems by reducing or eliminating otherwise-required manual adjustment of inaccuracies around the outline of the foreground subject (e.g., in post-production revisions to the alpha matte animation).

(89) As mentioned above, the video matte preparation system **102** can demosaic a digital video to extract the plurality of polarized digital videos from the digital video. For instance, FIG. 6 illustrates the video matte preparation system **102** generating polarized digital videos by demosaicing a raw digital video in accordance with one or more embodiments. Specifically, FIG. 6 shows the video matte preparation system **102** identifying a raw digital video **610** portraying an animation of a foreground subject backlit by a polarized light source. The video matte preparation system **102** demosaics the raw digital video **610** to extract polarized digital videos **602-608**. As illustrated in FIG. 6, the polarized digital videos **602-608** comprise corresponding frames. For instance, FIG. 6 shows a frame of the polarized digital video **602**, a corresponding frame of the polarized digital video **604**, a corresponding frame of the polarized digital video **606**, and a corresponding frame of the polarized digital video **608**. Each polarized digital video portrays light having different polarization angles (e.g., 0, 90, 45, and 135 degrees).

(90) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** obtains (e.g., receives,

identifies, captures, etc.) the raw digital video **610**. The raw digital video **610** comprises an array of pixels depicting light of various polarizations and/or colors. For instance, the raw digital video **610** comprises pixels specific to a first polarization angle, pixels specific to a second polarization angle, pixels specific to a third polarization angle, and pixels specific to a fourth polarization angle. As other example, the raw digital video **610** comprises pixels specific to a red color, pixels specific to a green color, and pixels specific to a blue color. To illustrate further, some pixels of the raw digital video **610** are specific to a red color at a first polarization angle, while some pixels of the raw digital video **610** are specific to a red color at a second polarization angle, etc. For example, a digital camera with a color and polarization filter comprising three unique color channels (e.g., RGB) and four unique polarization channels (e.g., 0, 45, 90, and 135 degrees) comprises twelve unique channels for each of the combinations of the unique colors and the unique polarization angles.

(91) In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** demosaics the raw digital video **610** by separating the pixels from the unique polarization channels into corresponding polarized digital videos. For each polarized digital video, the video matte preparation system **102** interpolates between retained pixels to fill in gaps from removed pixels. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** applies nearest-neighbor interpolation, bilinear interpolation, or bicubic interpolation on a grid comprising pixels of like polarization angle. In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** retains full color data in the polarized digital videos (e.g., the video matte preparation system **102** extracts polarized digital videos, each comprising red, green, and blue pixels). In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** separates colors as well as polarization angles (e.g., the video matte preparation system **102** extracts polarized digital videos comprising only red pixels, extracts other polarized digital videos comprising only green pixels, and extracts other polarized digital videos comprising only blue pixels). In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** demosaics the raw digital video **610** utilizing other techniques suitable for demosaicing polarized images.

(92) As mentioned previously, the video matte preparation system **102** can generate an alpha matte animation from the plurality of polarized digital videos. For instance, FIG. 7 illustrates, in accordance with one or more embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** generating an alpha matte **710** (e.g., a frame of the alpha matte animation) from corresponding frames **702-708** of the plurality of polarized digital videos.

(93) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** solves an optimization problem to generate the alpha matte animation. To illustrate, the video matte preparation system **102** models a quadratic programming problem for each pixel in a given frame of the digital video based on intensities of the corresponding pixels of the corresponding frames of the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos (or, alternatively, the plurality of polarized digital videos). For each pixel, the video matte preparation system **102** solves the quadratic programming problem to determine an alpha value for that pixel, thereby populating the alpha matte animation. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes a quadratic optimization library to solve the quadratic programming problem. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** iteratively determines alpha values that satisfy constraints of the quadratic programming problem until a cost function is minimized.

(94) In one or more embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** models a quadratic programming problem for a group of nearby pixels (e.g., a group of ten adjacent pixels or a group of sixteen adjacent pixels) in a given frame of the digital video based on intensities of the corresponding pixels of the group of nearby pixels of the corresponding frames of the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos (or, alternatively, the plurality of polarized digital videos). For the group of nearby pixels, the video matte preparation system **102** solves the quadratic programming problem to determine alpha values for that group of pixels, thereby populating the alpha matte animation. By grouping pixels in the quadratic programming problem in this way, the video matte preparation system **102** can increase efficiency (e.g., fewer total optimizations to solve)

without sacrificing the accuracy of the quadratic programming solution.

(95) By solving the quadratic programming problem, the video matte preparation system **102** can remove polarized or partially polarized reflections off of the foreground subject, yielding an alpha matte that captures fine details of the foreground subject without visual artifacts introduced by polarized reflections. For instance, if the foreground subject includes dielectric materials or has surfaces with a shiny quality, unpolarized ambient light may reflect off of the foreground subject partially polarized. The reflections of partially polarized light off of the foreground subject can cause visual artifacts in some of the polarized digital videos. However, the video matte preparation system **102** can eliminate or reduce such visual artifacts when solving the quadratic programming problem.

(96) For example, in some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** generates alpha mattes utilizing one or more approaches described in INSTANT MASKS WITH POLARIZED LIGHT, U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/536,384, filed on Nov. 29, 2021, the contents of which are incorporated by reference herein in their entirety.

(97) In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** generates alpha mattes utilizing a machine-learning model, such as a neural network. For instance, the video matte preparation system **102** processes the polarized digital videos utilizing an alpha-matte generation neural network trained to analyze polarized digital videos and predict pixel-wise locations of one or more foreground subjects in the polarized digital videos. The video matte preparation system **102** thereby utilizes the alpha-matte generation neural network to map the one or more foreground subjects onto an alpha matte animation. In this way, the video matte preparation system **102** can increase efficiency of alpha matte preparation. For instance, in some cases the video matte preparation system **102** generates alpha matte animations faster by utilizing the alpha-matte generation neural network than by utilizing other matting techniques. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** trains the alpha-matte generation neural network, for example, utilizing training datasets generated as described herein.

(98) As discussed above, the video matte preparation system **102** can composite the foreground subject with the replacement background to create a modified digital video. For instance, FIG. 8 illustrates the video matte preparation system **102** generating a modified digital video by combining the animation of the foreground subject and a replacement background utilizing the alpha matte animation in accordance with one or more embodiments. Specifically, FIG. 8 shows the video matte preparation system **102** compositing the foreground subject onto three different replacement backgrounds to generate three different modified digital videos.

(99) To illustrate, FIG. 8 depicts a frame **802** of a digital video portraying the foreground subject to be composited onto the replacement background. In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes a raw digital video (e.g., the raw digital video **610**) to composite the foreground subject with the replacement background. Alternatively, in some embodiments, the frame **802** is the frame **504** from the second polarized digital video comprising polarized light at an angle orthogonal to the polarization angle of the polarized light source. Thus, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes one of the polarized digital videos to composite the foreground subject with the replacement background. Moreover, in some embodiments, the frame **802** is the frame **524** from the second corrected polarized digital video comprising polarized light at an angle orthogonal to the polarization angle of the polarized light source, and corrected for intensity differences using techniques as described above. Thus, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes one of the corrected polarized digital videos to composite the foreground subject with the replacement background.

(100) By utilizing the second corrected polarized digital video (i.e., the corrected polarized digital video that comprises polarized light at an angle orthogonal to the polarization angle of the polarized light source) to composite the foreground subject onto the replacement background (as noted above for some embodiments), the video matte preparation system **102** can minimize (e.g.,

eliminate) edge lighting on the foreground subject from the polarized light source. In particular, because the second corrected polarized digital video comprises polarized light at an angle orthogonal to the polarization angle of the polarized light source, the light from the polarized light source is blocked by the polarized filter associated with the second corrected polarized digital video. Thus, in one or more implementations, the second corrected polarized digital video does not include light from the polarized light source, and therefore portrays the foreground subject without edge lighting surrounding the foreground subject.

(101) As further illustrated in FIG. 8, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** generates one or more modified digital videos. To demonstrate, the video matte preparation system **102** overlays the foreground subject from frame **802** onto replacement background frame **804** to generate frame **814** of a first modified digital video. Additionally, the video matte preparation system **102** overlays the foreground subject from frame **802** onto replacement background frame **806** to generate frame **816** of a second modified digital video. Further, the video matte preparation system **102** overlays the foreground subject from frame **802** onto replacement background frame **808** to generate frame **818** of a third modified digital video.

(102) To combine (e.g., composite, overlay, superimpose, etc.) the animation of the foreground subject and a replacement background to generate a modified digital video, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the alpha matte animation. As illustrated in FIG. 8, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes frame **810** of the alpha matte animation to generate frames **814**, **816**, and **818** of the first, second, and third modified digital videos. The frame **810** informs the video matte preparation system **102** for how to combine the animation of the foreground subject and the replacement background. For example, based on pixel values of the frame **810** of the alpha matte animation, the video matte preparation system **102** assigns weights to corresponding pixels of the frame **802** and the frame **804** to generate the frame **814**. For instance, if a pixel of the frame **810** has a value of one (e.g., a white pixel as shown in FIG. 8), the video matte preparation system **102** populates the corresponding pixel of the frame **814** with the full value of the corresponding pixel of the frame **802**, and none of the corresponding pixel of the frame **804**. Conversely, if a pixel of the frame **810** has a value of zero (e.g., a black pixel as shown in FIG. 8), the video matte preparation system **102** populates the corresponding pixel of the frame **814** with the full value of the corresponding pixel of the frame **804**, and none of the corresponding pixel of the frame **802**. Moreover, if a pixel of the frame **810** has a value of between zero and one (e.g., a gray pixel), the video matte preparation system **102** populates the corresponding pixel of the frame **814** with a weighted combination of the value of the corresponding pixel of the frame **802** and the value of the corresponding pixel of the frame **804**.

(103) To illustrate, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** determines a weighted average of pixels of the animation of the foreground subject and the replacement background in the RGB color space, wherein the weights are based on the values of the corresponding pixels of the alpha matte animation. For instance, the video matte preparation system **102** averages the red portion of a pixel of the frame **802** with the red portion of a corresponding pixel of the frame **804** to generate the red portion of a corresponding pixel of the frame **814**. Likewise, the video matte preparation system **102** averages, respectively, the green and blue portions of those pixels of the frames **802** and **804** to generate the green and blue portions of the corresponding pixel of the frame **814**. Alternatively, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** averages pixels of the animation of the foreground subject and the replacement background in a different color space (e.g., RYB, LAB, HSL, HSV). In some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** averages pixels of the animation of the foreground subject and the replacement background in a grayscale space.

(104) As mentioned above, in some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** generates a training dataset utilizing the techniques disclosed herein. For instance, the video matte preparation system **102** generates one or more modified digital videos (e.g., the first, second, and

third modified digital videos comprising, respectively, the frames **814**, **816**, and **818**). The video matte preparation system **102** stores and/or transmits the one or more modified digital videos to be used as one or more machine-learning training videos for the training dataset. Furthermore, the video matte preparation system **102** generates one or more alpha matte animations (e.g., the alpha matte animation comprising the frame **810**). The video matte preparation system **102** stores and/or transmits the one or more alpha matte animations to be used as one or more ground truth alpha matte animations for the one or more machine-learning training videos. To illustrate, the machine-learning training video(s) and the ground truth alpha matte animation(s) can be used to train a machine-learning model to generate new alpha matte animations for use in video matting systems. By generating multiple modified videos with different replacement backgrounds from one source animation of a foreground subject (e.g., as illustrated in FIG. **8**), the video matte preparation system **102** efficiently generates video matting datasets for machine-learning models.

(105) Moving to FIG. **9**, the video matte preparation system **102** can harmonize the foreground subject with the replacement background. For instance, FIG. **9** illustrates the video matte preparation system **102** generating the modified digital video, including harmonizing the foreground subject with the replacement background. Specifically, FIG. **9** shows the video matte preparation system **102** utilizing a harmonization machine learning model to harmonize the animation of the foreground subject with the replacement background.

(106) To illustrate, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the harmonization machine learning model **904** to analyze frame **902** of a modified digital video to determine luminosity differences between the foreground subject and the replacement background. Based on the luminosity differences, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the harmonization machine learning model **904** to adjust pixels of the foreground subject to reduce the luminosity differences. For example, as illustrated in FIG. **9**, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the harmonization machine learning model **904** to increase light intensities and/or adjust color values for some or all of the pixels representing the foreground subject. In this way, the video matte preparation system **102** generates frame **906** to construct a harmonized digital video.

(107) The video matte preparation system **102** utilizes any of a variety of harmonization machine learning models **904**. In some implementations of the video matte preparation system **102**, the harmonization machine learning model **904** utilizes spatial domain methods to determine image gradients and/or frequencies in the frame **902** of the modified digital video. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the harmonization machine learning model **904** to determine spatial derivatives of illumination and applies white balancing to normalize lighting conditions and generate the frame **906** of the harmonized digital video.

(108) In some embodiments of the video matte preparation system **102**, the harmonization machine learning model **904** utilizes color domain methods to analyze bright pixels and/or dark pixels for illuminant estimation. For instance, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the harmonization machine learning model **904** to estimate illumination directions considering first and second order moments of color, and to determine bright and dark pixels based on projections of color points in the color domain.

(109) In one or more embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** can train the harmonization machine learning model **904** to harmonize the foreground subject with the replacement background. For example, as discussed above, the video matte preparation system **102** can analyze a variety of input animations of a foreground subject and replacement backgrounds, and predict an optimal harmonized digital video based on the animations and the replacement backgrounds. The video matte preparation system **102** can utilize a ground truth harmonized digital video to train the harmonization machine learning model **904** to select harmonization parameters for any particular input animation of a foreground subject and replacement background.

(110) In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes one or more of a variety of computer-implemented algorithms for the harmonization machine learning model **904**.

For example, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes a trained neural network or a decision tree machine learning model. For instance, the video matte preparation system **102** can train the harmonization machine learning model **904** to select harmonization parameters based on a variety of input features, such as luminosity of a replacement background, luminosity of the animation of the foreground subject, overall colors of the replacement background, and/or overall color of the animation of the foreground subject.

(111) To illustrate, the video matte preparation system **102** encodes these input features (e.g., utilizing one-hot encoding or an embedding network). The video matte preparation system **102** can utilize layers having learned parameters to process the encoded features. At each layer, the neural network can generate intermediate latent feature vectors representing weighted features according to the learned parameters of the network. Utilizing a variety of activation, pooling, convolution, normalization, and/or dropout layers, the neural network can generate a prediction (e.g., harmonization parameters, a harmonized foreground subject, and/or a harmonized digital video).

(112) During training, the video matte preparation system **102** can learn parameters of the harmonization machine learning model **904**. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** can compare predictions generated by the harmonization machine learning model **904** with ground truth predictions (e.g., ground truth harmonized digital videos). In some implementations, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes a loss function to determine a measure of loss between the prediction and the ground truth. The video matte preparation system **102** then modifies parameters of the harmonization machine learning model **904** utilizing the measure of loss. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes gradient descent and backpropagation to modify the parameters of the harmonization machine learning model **904** to reduce the measure of loss. The video matte preparation system **102** can iteratively modify parameters utilizing training predictions and ground truths to train the harmonization machine learning model **904**.

(113) The video matte preparation system **102** can utilize a similar approach to train a machine-learning model to generate alpha matte animations. Indeed, as described above, the video matte preparation system **102** can prepare a training dataset comprising composite digital videos (machine-learning training videos) and ground truth alpha matte animations. The video matte preparation system **102** can utilize the approach just described to train the machine-learning model. For example, the video matte preparation system **102** can utilize the machine learning model to analyze an input machine-learning training video and generate a predicted alpha matte animation. The video matte preparation system **102** can then compare the predicted alpha matte animation with the ground truth alpha matte animation to determine a measure of loss. The video matte preparation system **102** can then modify parameters of the machine-learning model to more accurately generate alpha matte animations. Upon training the machine-learning model, in some embodiments, the video matte preparation system **102** utilizes the machine-learning model to generate alpha mattes (or alpha matte animations) from input images and/or input videos (e.g., from new captured images/videos portraying a subject in a foreground in front of a background).

(114) FIGS. **10A** and **10B** illustrate example modified digital images generated by the video matte preparation system **102**. For instance, as depicted in FIG. **10A**, the video matte preparation system **102** generated an alpha matte animation from a video of a profile view of a person juggling objects with one hand. FIG. **10A** depicts a frame **1002** from the alpha matte animation of the juggler. As can be seen in the frame **1002**, the video matte preparation system **102** captures motion blur of the juggled objects within the alpha matte animation. To illustrate, the video matte preparation system **102** captures motion blur in the alpha matte animation by assigning, for pixels located within the motion blur, values between fully transparent and fully opaque. In other words, for pixels at the locations of motion blur, the video matte preparation system **102** combines colors of the foreground subject with colors of the replacement background, thereby preserving the appearance of motion by the foreground subject without sacrificing detail of the replacement background behind the juggled objects.

(115) For another example, as depicted in FIG. 10B, the video matte preparation system 102 generated an alpha matte animation from a video of a profile view of a person with wavy hair. FIG. 10B depicts a frame 1004 from the alpha matte animation of the person with wavy hair. As can be seen in the frame 1004, the video matte preparation system 102 captures fine details of the wavy hair in the alpha matte animation. To illustrate, the video matte preparation system 102 captures fine details in the alpha matte animation by assigning, for pixels located in and around the wavy hair, values between fully transparent and fully opaque. In other words, for pixels at the locations of wavy hair, the video matte preparation system 102 combines colors of the foreground subject with colors of the replacement background, thereby preserving the appearance of the wavy hair of the person without sacrificing detail of the replacement background behind the wavy hair.

(116) Turning now to FIG. 11, additional detail will be provided regarding components and capabilities of one or more embodiments of the video matte preparation system 102. In particular, FIG. 11 illustrates an example video matte preparation system 102 executed by a computing device(s) 1100 (e.g., the server device(s) 106 or the client device 108). As shown by the embodiment of FIG. 11, the computing device(s) 1100 includes or hosts the video management system 104 and/or the video matte preparation system 102. Furthermore, as shown in FIG. 11, the video matte preparation system 102 includes a polarized digital video manager 1102, an intensity correction engine 1104, an alpha matte animation engine 1106, a modified digital video manager 1108, and a storage manager 1110.

(117) As just mentioned, and as shown in FIG. 11, the video matte preparation system 102 includes a polarized digital video manager 1102. The polarized digital video manager 1102 can capture, obtain, receive, create, extract, demosaic, generate, and/or transmit polarized digital videos. For example, as described above, the polarized digital video manager 1102 can capture a polarized digital video portraying a foreground subject backlit by a polarized light source (e.g., utilizing one or more camera devices having one or more polarized filters). The polarized digital video manager 1102 can also temporally and/or spatially crop a polarized digital video (e.g., utilizing markers in marker frames) as described above. The polarized digital video manager 1102 can also demosaic raw digital videos to extract polarized digital videos.

(118) In addition, as illustrated in FIG. 11, the video matte preparation system 102 includes an intensity correction engine 1104. The intensity correction engine 1104 can modify, correct, and/or adjust pixel intensity of one or more polarized digital videos. For example, as discussed above, the intensity correction engine 1104 can determine and apply correction metrics (e.g., scalar correction metrics) and correct intensity across polarized digital images utilizing a closed-form expression.

(119) Moreover, as shown in FIG. 11, the video matte preparation system 102 includes an alpha matte animation engine 1106. The alpha matte animation engine 1106 can generate, create, and/or construct an alpha matte animation. For instance, as described above, the alpha matte animation engine 1106 can generate an alpha matte from corrected polarized digital videos.

(120) Further, FIG. 11 illustrates that the video matte preparation system 102 includes a modified digital video manager 1108. The modified digital video manager 1108 can generate, create, and/or construct a modified digital video. For example, as described above, the modified digital video manager 1108 can composite a foreground subject animation from a digital video and a new background utilizing an alpha matte animation. In addition, the modified digital video manager 1108 can utilize a harmonization machine learning model to harmonize the foreground subject and new background in generating a modified digital video.

(121) Moreover, as shown in FIG. 11, the video matte preparation system 102 includes a storage manager 1110. The storage manager 1110 (implemented by one or more memory devices) stores data for the video matte preparation system 102. For example, the storage manager 1110 can include a polarized digital video, correction metrics, corrected polarized digital videos, alpha matte animations, or modified/composite digital videos.

(122) Each of the components 1102-1110 of the video matte preparation system 102 can include

software, hardware, or both. For example, the components **1102-1110** can include one or more instructions stored on a computer-readable storage medium and executable by processors of one or more computing devices, such as a client device or server device. When executed by the one or more processors, the computer-executable instructions of the video matte preparation system **102** can cause the computing device(s) **1100** to perform the methods described herein. Alternatively, the components **1102-1110** can include hardware, such as a special purpose processing device to perform a certain function or group of functions. Alternatively, the components **1102-1110** of the video matte preparation system **102** can include a combination of computer-executable instructions and hardware.

(123) Furthermore, the components **1102-1110** of the video matte preparation system **102** may, for example, be implemented as one or more operating systems, as one or more stand-alone applications, as one or more modules of an application, as one or more plug-ins, as one or more library functions or functions that may be called by other applications, and/or as a cloud-computing model. Thus, the components **1102-1110** may be implemented as a stand-alone application, such as a desktop or mobile application. Furthermore, the components **1102-1110** may be implemented as one or more web-based applications hosted on a remote server. The components **1102-1110** may also be implemented in a suite of mobile device applications or “apps.” To illustrate, the components **1102-1110** may be implemented in an application, including but not limited to ADOBE CREATIVE CLOUD, ADOBE PREMIERE, ADOBE ELEMENTS, ADOBE PHOTOSHOP, OR ADOBE LIGHTROOM. The foregoing are either registered trademarks or trademarks of Adobe Inc. in the United States and/or other countries.

(124) FIGS. **1-11**, the corresponding text, and the examples provide a number of different methods, systems, devices, and non-transitory computer-readable media of the video matte preparation system **102**. In addition to the foregoing, one or more embodiments can also be described in terms of flowcharts comprising acts for accomplishing a particular result, as shown in FIG. **12**. FIG. **12** may be performed with more or fewer acts. Further, the acts may be performed in differing orders. Additionally, the acts described herein may be repeated or performed in parallel with one another or parallel with different instances of the same or similar acts. The acts may be performed without user input (i.e., in an automated fashion upon initiation).

(125) As mentioned, FIG. **12** illustrates a flowchart of a series of acts **1200** for generating alpha mattes and/or generating modified digital videos in accordance with one or more embodiments. While FIG. **12** illustrates acts according to one embodiment, alternative embodiments may omit, add to, reorder, and/or modify any of the acts shown in FIG. **12**. The acts of FIG. **12** can be performed as part of a method. Alternatively, a non-transitory computer-readable medium can comprise instructions that, when executed by one or more processors, cause a computing device to perform the acts of FIG. **12**. In some embodiments, a system can perform the acts of FIG. **12**.

(126) As shown in FIG. **12**, the series of acts **1200** includes an act **1202** for obtaining polarized digital videos portraying an animation of a foreground subject and a polarized light source. In particular, the act **1202** can include obtaining a plurality of polarized digital videos portraying an animation of a foreground subject and a polarized light source. Moreover, the act **1202** can include obtaining a plurality of polarized digital videos portraying an animation of a foreground subject backlit by a polarized light source. Specifically, the act **1202** can include identifying a digital video portraying the animation of the foreground subject backlit by the polarized light source; and extracting the plurality of polarized digital videos from the digital video. Moreover, the act **1202** can include capturing, utilizing one or more polarized filters of a camera, a digital video portraying the animation of the foreground subject backlit by the polarized light source. Moreover, the act **1202** can include capturing, utilizing a plurality of polarized filters of a camera, a digital video portraying the animation of the foreground subject and the polarized light source. Furthermore, the act **1202** can include capturing a digital video portraying the animation of the foreground subject backlit by the polarized light source.

(127) In particular, the act **1202** can include obtaining a first polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a first angle; obtaining a second polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a second angle orthogonal to the first angle; obtaining a third polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a third angle; and obtaining a fourth polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a fourth angle orthogonal to the third angle. Moreover, the act **1202** can include obtaining a first polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a first angle; obtaining a second polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a second angle orthogonal to the first angle and orthogonal to a polarization angle of the polarized light source; obtaining a third polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a third angle; and obtaining a fourth polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a fourth angle orthogonal to the third angle.

(128) As also shown in FIG. **12**, the series of acts **1200** includes an act **1204** for generating correction metrics for the polarized digital videos. In particular, the act **1204** can include generating a plurality of correction metrics by comparing pixel-wise intensity values across corresponding frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos.

(129) Moreover, the act **1204** can include generating a first intensity correction metric based on: intensity values for corresponding first pixels of corresponding first frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos; and a first overall intensity value for the corresponding first pixels of the corresponding first frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos. Furthermore, the act **1204** can include generating a second intensity correction metric based on: intensity values for corresponding second pixels of corresponding second frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos; and a second overall intensity value for the corresponding second pixels of the corresponding second frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos.

(130) As further shown in FIG. **12**, the series of acts **1200** includes an act **1206** for generating corrected polarized digital videos. In particular, the act **1206** can include generating a plurality of corrected polarized digital videos by adjusting intensity values of the plurality of polarized digital videos utilizing the plurality of correction metrics. Moreover, the act **1206** can include generating a plurality of corrected polarized digital videos by adjusting intensity values of the plurality of polarized digital videos based on intensity differences across the plurality of polarized digital videos.

(131) Additionally, the act **1206** can include, for a first pixel of a first frame of the plurality of polarized digital videos: generating a first intensity correction metric based on intensity values for corresponding first pixels of corresponding first frames of the first polarized digital video, the second polarized digital video, the third polarized digital video, and the fourth polarized digital video; and generating, based on the first intensity correction metric, adjusted intensity values for the corresponding first pixels of the corresponding first frames of the first polarized digital video, the second polarized digital video, the third polarized digital video, and the fourth polarized digital video. Furthermore, the act **1206** can include, for a second pixel of the first frame of the plurality of polarized digital videos: generating a second intensity correction metric based on intensity values for corresponding second pixels of the corresponding first frames of the first polarized digital video, the second polarized digital video, the third polarized digital video, and the fourth polarized digital video; and generating, based on the second intensity correction metric, adjusted intensity values for the corresponding second pixels of the corresponding first frames of the first polarized digital video, the second polarized digital video, the third polarized digital video, and the fourth polarized digital video.

(132) Moreover, the act **1206** can include generating, based on the first intensity correction metric, a first set of adjusted intensity values for the corresponding first pixels of the corresponding first frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos. Furthermore, the act **1206** can include generating, based on the second intensity correction metric, a second set of adjusted intensity values for the corresponding second pixels of the corresponding second frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos.

(133) In some embodiments, the act **1206** more particularly includes wherein adjusting the intensity values of the plurality of polarized digital videos comprises solving a closed-form expression of intensity values for the first polarized digital video, the second polarized digital video, the third polarized digital video, and the fourth polarized digital video.

(134) As next shown in FIG. **12**, the series of acts **1200** includes an act **1208** for generating an alpha matte animation. In particular, the act **1208** can include generating a plurality of alpha mattes from the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos. Moreover, the act **1208** can include generating an alpha matte animation comprising a plurality of alpha mattes from the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos. Alternatively, the act **1208** can include generating a plurality of alpha mattes from the plurality of polarized digital videos. Moreover, the act **1208** can include generating an alpha matte animation comprising a plurality of alpha mattes from the plurality of polarized digital videos. Specifically, the act **1208** can include generating the alpha matte animation comprising the plurality of alpha mattes by solving a quadratic programming problem for a group of a plurality of nearby pixels. Furthermore, the act **1208** can include generating the alpha matte animation by utilizing an alpha-matte generation neural network to process the plurality of polarized digital videos.

(135) As further shown in FIG. **12**, the series of acts **1200** includes an act **1210** for generating a modified digital video from the animation of the foreground subject and the alpha matte animation. In particular, the act **1210** can include generating a modified digital video from the animation of the foreground subject and the plurality of alpha mattes. Moreover, the act **1210** can include generating a modified digital video by combining the animation of the foreground subject and a replacement background utilizing the alpha matte animation. Additionally, the act **1210** can include combining the animation of the foreground subject as displayed in the second polarized digital video with a replacement background utilizing the plurality of alpha mattes. Furthermore, the act **1210** can include harmonizing, utilizing a harmonization machine learning model, the animation of the foreground subject with the replacement background.

(136) Additionally, the series of acts **1200** can further include wherein the plurality of polarized digital videos comprises marker frames and non-marker frames, wherein the marker frames portray the polarized light source having a plurality of markers. The series of acts **1200** can include spatially cropping the plurality of polarized digital videos utilizing the plurality of markers from the polarized light source portrayed in the marker frames. In particular, the series of acts **1200** can include generating a spatial mask for the non-marker frames based on the plurality of markers from the polarized light source portrayed in the marker frames; and removing portions of the non-marker frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos that are outside of the spatial mask. Alternatively, the series of acts **1200** can further include wherein the plurality of polarized digital videos comprises marker frames portraying the polarized light source having a plurality of markers. The series of acts **1200** can include spatially cropping the plurality of polarized digital videos utilizing the plurality of markers from the polarized light source portrayed in the marker frames by: generating a spatial mask based on the plurality of markers; and removing portions of the plurality of polarized digital videos that are outside of the spatial mask.

(137) Further, the series of acts **1200** can include temporally cropping the plurality of polarized digital videos by removing the marker frames from the plurality of polarized digital videos. Moreover, the series of acts **1200** can include generating a training dataset, wherein generating the modified digital video comprises generating a machine-learning training video for the training dataset, and wherein generating the alpha matte animation comprises generating a ground truth alpha matte animation for the machine-learning training video.

(138) Embodiments of the present disclosure may comprise or utilize a special purpose or general purpose computer including computer hardware, such as, for example, one or more processors and system memory, as discussed in greater detail below. Embodiments within the scope of the present disclosure also include physical and other computer-readable media for carrying or storing

computer-executable instructions and/or data structures. In particular, one or more of the processes described herein may be implemented at least in part as instructions embodied in a non-transitory computer-readable medium and executable by one or more computing devices (e.g., any of the media content access devices described herein). In general, a processor (e.g., a microprocessor) receives instructions, from a non-transitory computer-readable medium, (e.g., a memory, etc.), and executes those instructions, thereby performing one or more processes, including one or more of the processes described herein.

(139) Computer-readable media can be any available media that can be accessed by a general purpose or special purpose computer system. Computer-readable media that store computer-executable instructions are non-transitory computer-readable storage media (devices). Computer-readable media that carry computer-executable instructions are transmission media. Thus, by way of example, and not limitation, embodiments of the disclosure can comprise at least two distinctly different kinds of computer-readable media: non-transitory computer-readable storage media (devices) and transmission media.

(140) Non-transitory computer-readable storage media (devices) includes RAM, ROM, EEPROM, CD-ROM, solid state drives (“SSDs”) (e.g., based on RAM), Flash memory, phase-change memory (“PCM”), other types of memory, other optical disk storage, magnetic disk storage or other magnetic storage devices, or any other medium which can be used to store desired program code means in the form of computer-executable instructions or data structures and which can be accessed by a general purpose or special purpose computer.

(141) A “network” is defined as one or more data links that enable the transport of electronic data between computer systems and/or generators and/or other electronic devices. When information is transferred, or provided over a network or another communications connection (either hardwired, wireless, or a combination of hardwired or wireless) to a computer, the computer properly views the connection as a transmission medium. Transmissions media can include a network and/or data links which can be used to carry desired program code means in the form of computer-executable instructions or data structures and which can be accessed by a general purpose or special purpose computer. Combinations of the above should also be included within the scope of computer-readable media.

(142) Further, upon reaching various computer system components, program code means in the form of computer-executable instructions or data structures can be transferred automatically from transmission media to non-transitory computer-readable storage media (devices) (or vice versa). For example, computer-executable instructions or data structures received over a network or data link can be buffered in RAM within a network interface generator (e.g., a “NIC”), and then eventually transferred to computer system RAM and/or to less volatile computer storage media (devices) at a computer system. Thus, it should be understood that non-transitory computer-readable storage media (devices) can be included in computer system components that also (or even primarily) utilize transmission media.

(143) Computer-executable instructions comprise, for example, instructions and data which, when executed at a processor, cause a general purpose computer, special purpose computer, or special purpose processing device to perform a certain function or group of functions. In one or more embodiments, computer-executable instructions are executed on a general purpose computer to turn the general purpose computer into a special purpose computer implementing elements of the disclosure. The computer-executable instructions may be, for example, binaries, intermediate format instructions such as assembly language, or even source code. Although the subject matter has been described in language specific to structural features and/or methodological acts, it is to be understood that the subject matter defined in the appended claims is not necessarily limited to the described features or acts described above. Rather, the described features and acts are disclosed as example forms of implementing the claims.

(144) Those skilled in the art will appreciate that the disclosure may be practiced in network

computing environments with many types of computer system configurations, including, personal computers, desktop computers, laptop computers, message processors, hand-held devices, multi-processor systems, microprocessor-based or programmable consumer electronics, network PCs, minicomputers, mainframe computers, mobile telephones, PDAs, tablets, pagers, routers, switches, and the like. The disclosure may also be practiced in distributed system environments where local and remote computer systems, which are linked (either by hardwired data links, wireless data links, or by a combination of hardwired and wireless data links) through a network, both perform tasks. In a distributed system environment, program generators may be located in both local and remote memory storage devices.

(145) Embodiments of the present disclosure can also be implemented in cloud computing environments. In this description, “cloud computing” is defined as a subscription model for enabling on-demand network access to a shared pool of configurable computing resources. For example, cloud computing can be employed in the marketplace to offer ubiquitous and convenient on-demand access to the shared pool of configurable computing resources. The shared pool of configurable computing resources can be rapidly provisioned via virtualization and released with low management effort or service provider interaction, and then scaled accordingly.

(146) A cloud-computing subscription model can be composed of various characteristics such as, for example, on-demand self-service, broad network access, resource pooling, rapid elasticity, measured service, and so forth. A cloud-computing subscription model can also expose various service subscription models, such as, for example, Software as a Service (“SaaS”), a web service, Platform as a Service (“PaaS”), and Infrastructure as a Service (“IaaS”). A cloud-computing subscription model can also be deployed using different deployment subscription models such as private cloud, community cloud, public cloud, hybrid cloud, and so forth. In this description and in the claims, a “cloud-computing environment” is an environment in which cloud computing is employed.

(147) FIG. 13 illustrates a block diagram of an example computing device **1300** that may be configured to perform one or more of the processes described above. One will appreciate that one or more computing devices, such as the computing device **1300** may represent the computing devices described above (e.g., the server device(s) **106** or the client device **108**). In one or more embodiments, the computing device **1300** may be a mobile device (e.g., a mobile telephone, a smartphone, a PDA, a tablet, a laptop, a camera, a tracker, a watch, a wearable device, etc.). In some embodiments, the computing device **1300** may be a non-mobile device (e.g., a desktop computer or another type of client device). Further, the computing device **1300** may be a server device that includes cloud-based processing and storage capabilities.

(148) As shown in FIG. 13, the computing device **1300** can include one or more processor(s) **1302**, memory **1304**, a storage device **1306**, input/output interfaces **1308** (or “I/O interfaces **1308**”), and a communication interface **1310**, which may be communicatively coupled by way of a communication infrastructure (e.g., bus **1312**). While the computing device **1300** is shown in FIG. 13, the components illustrated in FIG. 13 are not intended to be limiting. Additional or alternative components may be used in other embodiments. Furthermore, in certain embodiments, the computing device **1300** includes fewer components than those shown in FIG. 13. Components of the computing device **1300** shown in FIG. 13 will now be described in additional detail.

(149) In particular embodiments, the processor(s) **1302** includes hardware for executing instructions, such as those making up a computer program. As an example, and not by way of limitation, to execute instructions, the processor(s) **1302** may retrieve (or fetch) the instructions from an internal register, an internal cache, memory **1304**, or a storage device **1306** and decode and execute them.

(150) The computing device **1300** includes the memory **1304**, which is coupled to the processor(s) **1302**. The memory **1304** may be used for storing data, metadata, and programs for execution by the processor(s). The memory **1304** may include one or more of volatile and non-volatile memories,

such as Random-Access Memory (“RAM”), Read-Only Memory (“ROM”), a solid-state disk (“SSD”), Flash, Phase Change Memory (“PCM”), or other types of data storage. The memory **1304** may be internal or distributed memory.

(151) The computing device **1300** includes the storage device **1306** for storing data or instructions. As an example, and not by way of limitation, the storage device **1306** can include a non-transitory storage medium described above. The storage device **1306** may include a hard disk drive (“HDD”), flash memory, a Universal Serial Bus (“USB”) drive or a combination these or other storage devices.

(152) As shown, the computing device **1300** includes one or more I/O interfaces **1308**, which are provided to allow a user to provide input to (such as user strokes), receive output from, and otherwise transfer data to and from the computing device **1300**. These I/O interfaces **1308** may include a mouse, keypad or a keyboard, a touch screen, camera, optical scanner, network interface, modem, other known I/O devices or a combination of such I/O interfaces **1308**. The touch screen may be activated with a stylus or a finger.

(153) The I/O interfaces **1308** may include one or more devices for presenting output to a user, including, but not limited to, a graphics engine, a display (e.g., a display screen), one or more output drivers (e.g., display drivers), one or more audio speakers, and one or more audio drivers. In certain embodiments, I/O interfaces **1308** are configured to provide graphical data to a display for presentation to a user. The graphical data may be representative of one or more graphical user interfaces and/or any other graphical content as may serve a particular implementation.

(154) The computing device **1300** can further include a communication interface **1310**. The communication interface **1310** can include hardware, software, or both. The communication interface **1310** provides one or more interfaces for communication (such as, for example, packet-based communication) between the computing device and one or more other computing devices or one or more networks. As an example, and not by way of limitation, communication interface **1310** may include a network interface controller (“NIC”) or network adapter for communicating with an Ethernet or other wire-based network or a wireless NIC (“WNIC”) or wireless adapter for communicating with a wireless network, such as a WI-FI. The computing device **1300** can further include the bus **1312**. The bus **1312** can include hardware, software, or both that connects components of computing device **1300** to each other.

(155) The use in the foregoing description and in the appended claims of the terms “first,” “second,” “third,” etc., is not necessarily to connote a specific order or number of elements. Generally, the terms “first,” “second,” “third,” etc., are used to distinguish between different elements as generic identifiers. Absent a showing that the terms “first,” “second,” “third,” etc., connote a specific order, these terms should not be understood to connote a specific order. Furthermore, absent a showing that the terms “first,” “second,” “third,” etc., connote a specific number of elements, these terms should not be understood to connote a specific number of elements. For example, a first widget may be described as having a first side and a second widget may be described as having a second side. The use of the term “second side” with respect to the second widget may be to distinguish such side of the second widget from the “first side” of the first widget, and not necessarily to connote that the second widget has two sides.

(156) In the foregoing description, the invention has been described with reference to specific exemplary embodiments thereof. Various embodiments and aspects of the invention(s) are described with reference to details discussed herein, and the accompanying drawings illustrate the various embodiments. The description above and drawings are illustrative of the invention and are not to be construed as limiting the invention. Numerous specific details are described to provide a thorough understanding of various embodiments of the present invention.

(157) The present invention may be embodied in other specific forms without departing from its spirit or essential characteristics. The described embodiments are to be considered in all respects only as illustrative and not restrictive. For example, the methods described herein may be

performed with fewer or more steps/acts or the steps/acts may be performed in differing orders. Additionally, the steps/acts described herein may be repeated or performed in parallel with one another or in parallel with different instances of the same or similar steps/acts. The scope of the invention is, therefore, indicated by the appended claims rather than by the foregoing description. All changes that come within the meaning and range of equivalency of the claims are to be embraced within their scope.

Claims

1. A method comprising: obtaining a plurality of polarized digital videos portraying an animation of a foreground subject backlit by a polarized light source; generating a plurality of corrected polarized digital videos by adjusting intensity values of the plurality of polarized digital videos based on intensity differences across the plurality of polarized digital videos; generating an alpha matte animation comprising a plurality of alpha mattes from the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos; and generating a modified digital video by combining the animation of the foreground subject and a replacement background utilizing the alpha matte animation.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein obtaining the plurality of polarized digital videos comprises: identifying a digital video portraying the animation of the foreground subject backlit by the polarized light source; and extracting the plurality of polarized digital videos from the digital video.
3. The method of claim 1, wherein the plurality of polarized digital videos comprises marker frames and non-marker frames, wherein the marker frames portray the polarized light source having a plurality of markers, and wherein the method further comprises spatially cropping the plurality of polarized digital videos utilizing the plurality of markers from the polarized light source portrayed in the marker frames.
4. The method of claim 3, further comprising temporally cropping the plurality of polarized digital videos by removing the marker frames from the plurality of polarized digital videos.
5. The method of claim 1, wherein obtaining the plurality of polarized digital videos comprises: obtaining a first polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a first angle; obtaining a second polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a second angle orthogonal to the first angle; obtaining a third polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a third angle; and obtaining a fourth polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a fourth angle orthogonal to the third angle.
6. The method of claim 5, wherein generating the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos comprises, for a first pixel of a first frame of the plurality of polarized digital videos: generating a first intensity correction metric based on intensity values for corresponding first pixels of corresponding first frames of the first polarized digital video, the second polarized digital video, the third polarized digital video, and the fourth polarized digital video; and generating, based on the first intensity correction metric, adjusted intensity values for the corresponding first pixels of the corresponding first frames of the first polarized digital video, the second polarized digital video, the third polarized digital video, and the fourth polarized digital video.
7. The method of claim 6, wherein generating the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos comprises, for a second pixel of the first frame of the plurality of polarized digital videos: generating a second intensity correction metric based on intensity values for corresponding second pixels of the corresponding first frames of the first polarized digital video, the second polarized digital video, the third polarized digital video, and the fourth polarized digital video; and generating, based on the second intensity correction metric, adjusted intensity values for the corresponding second pixels of the corresponding first frames of the first polarized digital video, the second polarized digital video, the third polarized digital video, and the fourth polarized digital video.
8. The method of claim 5, wherein adjusting the intensity values of the plurality of polarized digital

videos comprises solving a closed-form expression of intensity values for the first polarized digital video, the second polarized digital video, the third polarized digital video, and the fourth polarized digital video.

9. The method of claim 1, further comprising generating a training dataset, wherein generating the modified digital video comprises generating a machine-learning training video for the training dataset, and wherein generating the alpha matte animation comprises generating a ground truth alpha matte animation for the machine-learning training video.

10. A system comprising: a memory component; and one or more processing devices coupled to the memory component, the one or more processing devices to perform operations comprising: obtaining a plurality of polarized digital videos portraying an animation of a foreground subject and a polarized light source; generating a plurality of correction metrics by comparing pixel-wise intensity values across corresponding frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos; generating a plurality of corrected polarized digital videos by adjusting intensity values of the plurality of polarized digital videos utilizing the plurality of correction metrics; generating a plurality of alpha mattes from the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos; and generating a modified digital video from the animation of the foreground subject and the plurality of alpha mattes.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein obtaining the plurality of polarized digital videos comprises capturing, utilizing one or more polarized filters of a camera, a digital video portraying the animation of the foreground subject and the polarized light source.

12. The system of claim 10, wherein obtaining the plurality of polarized digital videos comprises: obtaining a first polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a first angle; obtaining a second polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a second angle orthogonal to the first angle and orthogonal to a polarization angle of the polarized light source; obtaining a third polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a third angle; and obtaining a fourth polarized digital video comprising polarized light at a fourth angle orthogonal to the third angle.

13. The system of claim 12, wherein generating the modified digital video from the animation of the foreground subject and the plurality of alpha mattes comprises combining the animation of the foreground subject as displayed in the second polarized digital video with a replacement background utilizing the plurality of alpha mattes.

14. The system of claim 10, wherein generating the plurality of correction metrics comprises generating a first intensity correction metric based on: intensity values for corresponding first pixels of corresponding first frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos; and a first overall intensity value for the corresponding first pixels of the corresponding first frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos; and wherein generating the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos comprises generating, based on the first intensity correction metric, a first set of adjusted intensity values for the corresponding first pixels of the corresponding first frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos.

15. The system of claim 14, wherein generating the plurality of correction metrics comprises generating a second intensity correction metric based on: intensity values for corresponding second pixels of corresponding second frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos; and a second overall intensity value for the corresponding second pixels of the corresponding second frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos; and wherein generating the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos comprises generating, based on the second intensity correction metric, a second set of adjusted intensity values for the corresponding second pixels of the corresponding second frames of the plurality of polarized digital videos.

16. A non-transitory computer-readable medium storing executable instructions which, when executed by a processing device, cause the processing device to perform operations comprising: obtaining a plurality of polarized digital videos portraying an animation of a foreground subject backlit by a polarized light source; generating a plurality of corrected polarized digital videos by adjusting intensity values of the plurality of polarized digital videos based on intensity differences

across the plurality of polarized digital videos; generating an alpha matte animation comprising a plurality of alpha mattes from the plurality of corrected polarized digital videos; and generating a modified digital video by combining the animation of the foreground subject and a replacement background utilizing the alpha matte animation.

17. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 16, wherein generating the alpha matte animation comprising the plurality of alpha mattes comprises solving a quadratic programming problem for a group of a plurality of nearby pixels.

18. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 16, wherein the plurality of polarized digital videos comprises marker frames portraying the polarized light source having a plurality of markers, and wherein the operations further comprise spatially cropping the plurality of polarized digital videos utilizing the plurality of markers from the polarized light source portrayed in the marker frames by: generating a spatial mask based on the plurality of markers; and removing portions of the plurality of polarized digital videos that are outside of the spatial mask.

19. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 16, wherein generating the modified digital video comprises harmonizing, utilizing a harmonization machine learning model, the animation of the foreground subject with the replacement background.

20. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 16, further comprising generating a training dataset, wherein generating the modified digital video comprises generating a machine-learning training video for the training dataset, and wherein generating the alpha matte animation comprises generating a ground truth alpha matte animation for the machine-learning training video.
